International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad

HS8.202: Gender, Culture and Representation

Mid Semester Examination

Max. Time: 90 min. Instructions: **Full Marks: 30**

- Answer **any three** questions out of the given five.
- All questions carry equal marks **(10 marks each)**.
- Substantiate your arguments by providing relevant evidences from the texts.
- Each answer should be within 1000 words.

Questions

Q1. In *We Should All Be Feminists*, Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie argues that feminism is not merely a political ideology but an ethical and social necessity. Discuss how Adichie redefines feminism for a contemporary global audience. How does she challenge stereotypes associated with the term "feminist"?

Q2. Discuss *The Yellow Wallpaper* as a critique of patriarchal medical and domestic structures. How does the narrator's psychological breakdown reflect the consequences of silencing women's voices?

Q3. Mahasweta Devi's *Bayen* presents a powerful intersection of caste, gender, and superstition. Analyse how the protagonist becomes a victim of social exclusion. How does the text critique structural violence within rural society?

Q4. Compare the representation of masculinity in *A Little Book on Men* and the film *Firaaq*. How do both texts interrogate the idea of "manhood" in the context of power, vulnerability, and violence?

Q5. Across the prescribed texts, silence emerges as a recurring motif. Discuss how silence operates as both oppression and resistance in any two texts from the syllabus.